was somewhere between a final status agreement and a capitulation to the reality of terror, international pressure, and boycotts. It was designed to change the situation in the short and medium term and to prepare Israel for possible extreme scenarios—the ripening of conditions for a diplomatic process to resolve the conflict, or the collapse of the Palestinian Authority and the chaos that would ensue. The plan's principal ideas included the following:

- It was an Israeli initiative that was not conditional upon the existence of a partner for peace.
- Comprehensive responsibility for security in the entire area needed to be in the hands of the IDF until a final status agreement was reached.
- There had to be a separation from the Palestinians—we needed to be living side by side and not among each other.
- We were committed to the two-state solution.
- Practical steps had to be taken in the fields of security, civilian and economic life, and diplomacy, to be applied in Judea and Samaria, Jerusalem, and Gaza.

A Parallel Arrangement: An Alternative to Bilateral Negotiations

By my count, the history of the Israeli-Palestinian conflict began in the 1860s with the arrival of the first Jewish pioneers, full of Zionist motivation, from eastern Europe. The founding of the Hashomer defense organization in 1909 marked the beginning of the armed struggle between the Jewish and Palestinian populations. Since then, the political conflict between the two peoples has not ceased for a moment.

A key insight that applies to the various junctions and milestones throughout this protracted political struggle is that whenever the parties have been faced with a concrete proposal advanced by the superpowers and international bodies, the Israeli side has generally agreed to it and the Palestinian side has refused. A second insight is that whenever the conflict has flared up in violent confrontation, the Israeli side has usually prevailed, but Palestinian obstinacy has become more extreme after every defeat. It is